Grade 4 Informational Reading Assessment

Learning to Prepare Food

Name:
Date:

Directions: Read the passage below. Then answer Questions 1–8. Choose the best answer for each question. You may look back at the passage as you work.

Reading Passage

Paragraph 1

1 Learning to prepare food can help children in many ways. With an
2 adult nearby, children can take part in safe jobs such as washing
3 fruits and vegetables, measuring ingredients, mixing a salad, or
4 setting the table. These activities can help children learn about
5 food, practice useful skills, and feel more confident.

Paragraph 2

6 First, helping with food can teach children about making balanced
7 choices. While preparing a snack or meal, they may notice that foods
8 come in many colors, flavors, and forms. For example, a child might
9 help combine beans, corn, tomatoes, and herbs for a simple salad.
10 Seeing and touching ingredients can make trying new foods feel less
11 unfamiliar. Children can also learn simple food-safety habits, such
12 as washing their hands before preparing food and keeping work areas
13 clean.

Paragraph 3

14 Preparing food also gives children practice with thinking skills. A
15 recipe may ask them to read directions in order, count spoonfuls,
16 measure ingredients, or notice how a mixture changes. If a recipe
17 serves four people but six people will eat, an adult can help
18 children think about how the amounts might change. These small
19 decisions show that food preparation can involve reading, math,
20 planning, and problem solving.

Paragraph 4

21 In addition, children may become more confident when they contribute

to a meal or snack. A child who helps make a fruit salad, assemble a sandwich, or choose herbs for soup can see a useful result of their work. Families and communities prepare food in many different ways, and children can learn about traditions by helping with familiar dishes or discovering new ones. The important part is not making a perfect meal. It is learning, participating, and working safely with guidance.

Paragraph 5

Children do not need to use sharp knives, hot ovens, or other equipment on their own to take part in food preparation. Adults can choose tasks that fit a child's experience and supervise when needed. By starting with simple, safe jobs, children can build knowledge, thinking skills, and confidence that may help them throughout their lives.

Questions

1. Which detail from paragraph 1 supports the central idea that food preparation can benefit children?

A. Children can wash fruits and vegetables with an adult nearby.
B. Children can notice foods in many colors, flavors, and forms.
C. Children can learn about traditions by helping with familiar dishes.
D. Children can use reading and math to adjust a recipe.

2. What is the main idea of the passage?

A. Food cleanliness is the most important part of preparing food.
B. Learning to prepare food can help children build knowledge, thinking skills, and confidence.
C. Preparing food is mainly a way for children to make healthier choices.
D. Preparing food is mainly a way to learn about family and community traditions.

3. Which detail is included in paragraph 2?

A. Children can notice that foods come in different colors, flavors, and forms.
B. Children can make a salad with lettuce, radishes, and cucumbers.
C. Touching ingredients can make new foods seem less familiar.
D. Choosing herbs for soup helps children see the result of their work.

4. How do planning and measuring in paragraph 3 support the main idea of the passage?

A. They help children learn useful thinking skills, such as reading, math, planning, and problem solving.
B. They help children learn about family dishes and community traditions.
C. They show that only recipes that serve four people can be changed.
D. They help children learn only how to measure ingredients.

5. Which sentence best summarizes paragraph 3?

A. Preparing food helps children practice reading, math, planning, and problem solving.
B. Problem solving is the most important skill children gain from preparing food.
C. Preparing food is mainly about changing ingredient amounts for larger groups.
D. Preparing food helps children learn about familiar family dishes.

6. How can preparing food help children gain confidence?

A. Children can help make food and see a useful result of their work.
B. Children can help with a dish, even if they never see the final result.
C. Children can learn about family traditions without gaining confidence in their skills.
D. Children can gain confidence only by making a meal independently.

7. Why is adult guidance part of the passage's main idea?

A. Adults can choose safe tasks that fit a child's experience and supervise when needed.
B. Adults can teach children about family traditions through food preparation.
C. Adults can let children use all kitchen tools as long as they avoid hot ovens and sharp knives.
D. Adults should wait to involve children until they can use every kitchen tool.

8. Which detail is least important to include in a summary of the passage?

A. Children can help combine beans, corn, tomatoes, and herbs for a simple salad.
B. Children can practice thinking skills, including reading directions and solving problems.
C. Children can gain confidence by contributing to food preparation.
D. Adults can select safe tasks and supervise children when needed.